# PROFANE ATTACK

A strategy game for the Sharp PC-1500, PC-1500A and Tandy PC-2

Instructions – version 1.6

## 1. The game

The Cathodic Church (CC) – a fictional organisation – holds ten places, numbered 0 to 9: **Lourdes** (France), **Fatima** (Portugal), **Altotting** (Germany), **Santiago de Compostela** (Spain), **Jasna Gora** (Poland), **Avila** (Spain), **Loreto** (Italy), **Hohensalzburg** (Austria), **Weltenburg** (Germany) and the **Vatican**. Each place is defended by militants and keeps valuable relics and gold. You lead a small group of anticlericals and mercenaries, armed with inverted crosses and brimstones. New volunteers join you as you conquer places, and you can buy jihadists (steadfast and valiant warriors) and mercenaries. Conquer all ten places to win the war.

The first places are easy. Every next place is harder than the one before, and the last three, places 7, 8 and 9, are **the richest places**: they start with twice as many militants and twice as much gold, but not with twice as many relics, so what one of them gives you is not enough to conquer the next one. The richest of all is the Vatican (place 9). Every place also hides its own treasure.

## 2. What you need

- A Sharp **PC-1500A**, or a **PC-1500** or **Tandy PC-2** with a RAM module (CE-151 or larger). The recording holds the program without its REM lines (5537 bytes); with its variables it needs about 5.9 KB of memory, so it does not fit into a PC-1500 or PC-2 without a module.
- To load the recording: the **CE-150** printer/cassette interface (for the PC-2: the Radio Shack printer/cassette interface) and a computer, phone or player that can play WAV files.

## 3. Loading the game

1. Switch off the computer, insert it into the CE-150 and connect the audio output of the computer or player to the **EAR** jack of the CE-150.
2. Switch on, select PRO mode and type `NEW0` [ENTER], then `CLOAD` [ENTER].
3. Play `profane_attack-v1.6.wav` (name on the tape: `PROFANE`, about 7 minutes). If the program does not load, try again with another volume.
4. Select RUN mode and type `RUN` [ENTER].

You can also type in the listing `profane_attack-v1.6.txt`. Leave out the REM lines: the recording does not contain them either, and with them the program would not leave enough memory for its variables on a PC-1500A. The place names and treasures in lines 970–986 contain small letters (SML key).

## 4. Start and main menu

The game shows `Starting..` while it prepares the places, then its title while it plays the opening of J.S. Bach's Toccata in D minor, then `CONQUER BASTIONS OF FAITH` and the main menu:

```
FIGHT/BUY/SELL/RES/END?
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Press one key, without ENTER:

| Key | Action |
|---|---|
| F | Fight: attack a place (section 7) |
| B | Buy weapons, jihadists and mercenaries (section 8) |
| S | Sell relics, mercenaries and jihadists (section 9) |
| R | Show your resources (section 10) |
| E | End the game (section 11) |

Other keys are ignored. Numbers (“HOW MANY…?”, and when buying or selling the number after the price) are typed and confirmed with ENTER. A wrong number gives a beep and the question again.

## 5. Your forces

At the start you have:

| Resource | Start |
|---|---|
| Anticlericals | 10 |
| Mercenaries | 5 |
| Jihadists | 0 |
| Inverted crosses | 20 |
| Brimstones | 4 |
| Relics | 0 |
| Gold | 1000 |

### People

- **Anticlericals** (ANTI on the display) are the first to fall when the militants strike back.
- **Mercenaries** are attacked only when no anticlericals are left, and they are harder to kill. Every conquered place gives you new mercenaries, and you can also buy them.
- **Jihadists** fight in every fight, without being chosen, and stay with you until they are killed. Militants hunt them too, but less often. Each jihadist allows you to eliminate five fighters in each round.

Your people are anticlericals + mercenaries + jihadists. When all of them are gone, the Cathodic Church (CC) wins.

### Weapons

- **Inverted Cross:** instils terror among Cathodics and allows you to eliminate one fighter in each round of combat.
- **Brimstone:** has a deadly effect with demonic sulphur, which terrifies Cathodics, and allows you to eliminate three fighters in each round.

Not every strike succeeds. You choose the crosses and brimstones for each fight; they are used up by that fight.

## 6. The places

At the start of the game the places hold:

| Place | Name | Militants | Relics | Gold |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | Lourdes | 13 | 5 | 400 |
| 1 | Fatima | 22 | 9 | 300 |
| 2 | Altotting | 33 | 13 | 600 |
| 3 | Santiago de C. | 50 | 17 | 900 |
| 4 | Jasna Gora | 75 | 21 | 1200 |
| 5 | Avila | 115 | 25 | 1500 |
| 6 | Loreto | 182 | 29 | 1800 |
| 7 | Hohensalzburg | 588 | 33 | 4200 |
| 8 | Weltenburg | 976 | 37 | 4800 |
| 9 | Vatican | 1646 | 41 | 5400 |

Places 7, 8 and 9 (shaded) are the richest places.

## 7. Fight

1. Press **F**. The game asks `WHICH PLACE 0-9 (L=LIST)?`. Press the number of the place. **L** shows all places, one per second, e.g. `2 Altotting: 25 MIL` (militants still there) or `0 Lourdes: YOURS`. Any other key returns to the main menu.
2. The place is shown, two seconds per screen: `PLACE 3: Santiago de C.`, `50 MILITANTS`, `17 RELICS, 900 GOLD`. If the place is already yours, the game shows e.g. `Lourdes IS YOURS` and asks for the place again.
3. `HOW MANY CROSSES?` and `HOW MANY BRIMSTONES?`: type a number (0 is allowed) and ENTER. If you ask for more than you have, the game beeps, shows e.g. `YOU HAVE 20 CROSSES` and asks again. Without crosses, brimstones and jihadists you cannot fight: `NO WEAPONS: NO CHANCE!`.
4. `ENTER=FIGHT  3=RETREAT`: press **3** to retreat (you get your crosses and brimstones back) or **ENTER** to fight.
5. First `FIGHTING!` appears in the middle of the display; then your army and the militants march twice from both sides of the display, and each time they meet, the game beeps. Then the rounds begin.

### Rounds

The fight is played in rounds:

- Your side strikes first: the crosses and brimstones you chose and all your jihadists. The first strike is the weakest, because the militants are still behind their walls; from the second round on your weapons hit more often. However many weapons you take, at most a third of the militants the place had at the start of the fight fall in one strike: the others take cover. So the militants are eliminated step by step, in three strikes or more.
- Then the militants who are still alive strike back: they kill anticlericals; when no anticlericals are left, they turn on the mercenaries. Groups of militants can also kill jihadists.
- On the display, the game first shows `ROUND1: CC m vs YOU p` with both sides at full strength: the militants of the place and all your people. After every strike the next round (`ROUND2`, `ROUND3` …) shows what is left: the militants still alive after your strike and your people still alive after theirs. The last round shows `CC 0` when you win or `YOU 0` when you lose. Between `ROUND1` and `ROUND2` the game shows `Hurling inv. crosses!` when you fight with crosses and `Spewing brimstones!` when you fight with brimstones.

The same crosses and brimstones fight again in every round, until no militants or none of your people are left. A fight cannot be stopped once it has begun. The crosses and brimstones are used up whatever the result.

### You won

A triumph melody plays while the first screen shows e.g. `YOU WON! Lourdes IS YOURS`. A longer place name does not fit on the display, so after the melody the line moves to the left until you can read its end. The line stays about 1.5 seconds after the melody, and the next screens follow by themselves, about 1.5 seconds each:

`YOU GOT g GOLD`
`r RELICS c CROSSES`

- You got all the gold and all the relics of the place, and some crosses (more at the higher places), which will serve as inverted crosses!

`AND ALSO YOU GOT:`

- Then the treasure of the place, e.g. `barrel of Holy Water` at Lourdes. Every place has its own treasure; it is a trophy and does not change your resources.

`LOST: m MERC a ANTI j JIH`

- Your human losses in this fight.

`GOT y NEW MERC, z ANTI`

- A quarter of the militants of the place join you as mercenaries. The more gold a place gives you, the more new anticlericals join you, because Cathodic people were outraged by how much gold was stored there.

The place is now yours.

### You lost

`YOU LOST!` appears in the middle of the display while a falling melody plays, and then it blinks three times. Your losses follow; these screens change by themselves, about 1.5 seconds each. The CC also takes some of your gold and relics: `LOST g GOLD, r RELICS`. As a fight only ends when one side has nobody left, a lost fight always means `NO PEOPLE LEFT!` and `GAME OVER! Cathodics won`. Then, two seconds later, it shows `..but you have got...` and the treasure of the last place you conquered, or `lesson in humility..` if you have not conquered any. Meanwhile the second phrase of Bach's Toccata plays.

### A place breaks free

Once you have conquered Avila (place 5) or a higher place, the Cathodics start to fight back. From time to time, on the way back to the main menu (after a fight, after shopping and so on), one of your places rises against you: the game shows e.g. `Loreto broke free!` while the second phrase of Bach's Toccata plays; then the message blinks three times and the main menu comes back. It is never the place of your last fight. Its militants, relics and gold are back as at the start of the game, and you can conquer it again. To win the war, all ten places must be yours at the same time.

## 8. Buy

Press **B**. The game shows `C)ROSS B)RIM J)IHAD M)ERC`:

| Key | Item | Price (gold) |
|---|---|---|
| C | Inverted cross | 25 |
| B | Brimstone | 80 |
| J | Jihadist | 500 |
| M | Mercenary | 150 |

The game shows the price and how many you can afford, e.g. `PRICE 25 (MAX 40) ?`. Type the number on the same line, right after the question mark, e.g. `PRICE 25 (MAX 40) ? 12`, and press ENTER (ENTER alone buys nothing). Any key other than a digit wipes the number, so you can type it again; more than you can afford gives a beep and the question again. If you cannot afford even one, the game beeps, shows `NOT ENOUGH GOLD` for a second and the buy menu comes back at once. After a purchase the buy menu comes back too: buy something else or press any other key to return to the main menu.

## 9. Sell

Press **S**. The game first shows what you have to sell, e.g. `REL 9 MERC 12 JIH 2` (relics, mercenaries, jihadists) and waits until you press any key. Then it asks `SELL R)EL M)ERC J)IHAD?`:

| Key | Item | Price (gold) |
|---|---|---|
| R | Relic | random |
| M | Mercenary | 100 |
| J | Jihadist | 400 |

Press **R**, **M** or **J**; any other key returns to the main menu. The game shows the price of one piece and how many you have, e.g. `PRICE 400 (MAX 2) ?`. Type the number right after the question mark, as when buying, and press ENTER (ENTER alone sells nothing). Then it shows `GOLD NOW` g and the sell menu comes back.

The price of a relic is random. It stays the same until your next fight and then changes. Mercenaries and jihadists sell for less than they cost. You cannot sell your last people: the game shows `KEEP SOMEONE!`. If you have none of the chosen item, it shows `NOTHING TO SELL`.

## 10. Resources

Press **R**. After `YOU HAVE:` the game shows your people (`ANTI`, `MERC`, `JIHAD`), your weapons (`CROSS`, `BRIMSTONES`), then your `GOLD` and `RELICS`, one screen at a time. Press any key to see the next screen; after the last one the main menu comes back.

## 11. End

Press **E**. `QUIT GAME (Y/N)?`: **Y** ends the game and shows your gold (`BYE! GOLD` g); any other key returns to the main menu.

## 12. Winning and losing

- You win the war when all ten places are yours: `ALL PLACES ARE YOURS!` and `YOU BEAT THE CATHODICS!`. The second message appears by itself while the whole opening of Bach's Toccata plays; then the display is cleared and the game ends.
- You lose when none of your people are left: `GAME OVER! Cathodics won`.

## 13. Tips

- Your weapons strike in every round, but at most a third of the militants fall in one strike: more weapons than that are wasted. The longer a fight lasts, the more people you lose, and if you lose them all, the game is over. As a rough guide, take about one cross for every militant, and have people (anticlericals, mercenaries and jihadists together) numbering about two fifths of the militants.
- Your income is the gold and the relics of the conquered places. Sell relics when the price is good; if it is low, keep them: the price changes after your next fight.
- Save gold and relics from the first places for the rich places 7, 8 and 9: each of them is a big step up, and what one of them gives you is not enough for the next one. If you use up all your gold in every fight, you will not get through Weltenburg and the Vatican.
- Jihadists are expensive, but they are the most valiant and enduring, and they fight again in every following fight. They pay off best when bought early.
- Mercenaries are cheap shields: they do not kill anyone, but every fight lasts at least three strikes, and after each of them the militants strike back. Take enough people into every fight, or buy mercenaries before it.
- Surplus mercenaries and jihadists can be sold for gold, but every one you sell is one fewer to take the militants' blows.
- The mercenaries you win are your reserve of people. Check your forces with **R** and the places with **L** before you attack.
- Changed your mind before the fight? Press **3** to retreat: you lose nothing.